

Module 1: The Communication Process, Principles, and Ethics

1. Definitions of Communication

- **General Definition:** The process of sharing meaning in any context.
- **Julia Wood (2003):** A *systematic process* in which people interact with and through symbols to create and interpret meanings.

2. The 6 Components of Communication

Communication operates as a continuous system with six core elements:

1. **Context:** The environment or setting where communication takes place.
 - **Physical:** The concrete location/setting (e.g., classroom, office).
 - **Social:** The relationship between/among participants (e.g., friends, boss-employee).
 - **Historical:** Background formed by previous interactions influencing current understanding.
 - **Psychological:** Moods, feelings, and emotions brought into the encounter.
 - **Cultural:** Shared beliefs, values, and norms of a large group (*Lustig & Koester, 1993*).
2. **Participants:** The communicators (*Sender* encodes/sends; *Receiver* decodes/processes/reacts).
3. **Message:** The encoded ideas, thoughts, or information transmitted.
4. **Channel:** The route traveled by the message and means of transportation (transmitted via sensory channels) (*Verderber, 1999*).
5. **Noise:** Any interference with message transmission or understanding:
 - **External Noise:** Environmental sights, sounds, or physical distractions.
 - **Internal Noise:** Mental/emotional distractions (e.g., daydreaming, worrying).
 - **Semantic Noise:** Unintended meanings or emotional reactions triggered by certain words/symbols that block comprehension.
6. **Feedback:** The receiver's response/reaction to the message.

3. Levels of Communication

- **Verbal:** Communication involving words—whether spoken, written, or signed.
- **Non-verbal:** Body language without words (gestures, facial expressions, eye contact, posture, and touch/haptics).
- **Intrapersonal:** Communication within oneself; cognitive processing, self-talk, and decision-making to build self-understanding and self-esteem.
- **Interpersonal:** Interaction between two people establishing a communicative relationship (e.g., dialogues, interviews, small group discussions).
- **Public:** A speaker addressing an audience, either directly (face-to-face) or indirectly (via broadcast media like TV/radio).

4. Functions of Communication

- **To meet needs:** Basic human social need to connect (like food and shelter).
- **To enhance or maintain sense of self:** Learning who we are through others' feedback.
- **To fulfill social obligations:** Everyday greetings, courtesy, and conventions.
- **To develop, maintain, and deepen relationships:** The lifeblood of interpersonal bonds.
- **To exchange information:** Sharing observations, reading material, or media.
- **To influence others:** Persuasion, motivation, and encouragement.

5. The 6 Principles of Communication

1. **Communication is purposive:** It accomplishes specific trivial or significant goals; different goals demand different strategies.
2. **Communication is continuous:** Nonstop; even silence and involuntary nonverbal cues communicate reactions to the environment.
3. **Communication is relational:** Partners negotiate, build, sustain, or dissolve relationships through every exchange.
4. **Communication has ethical implications:** Every message involves choices that carry ethical responsibility and require ethical standards.
5. **Communication is learned:** It is an acquired skill developed through practice (active listening, processing, and speaking), not merely talking.
6. **Communication messages vary in conscious encoding:** Ranges from spontaneous reactions to learned scripts, to carefully planned, constructed messages.

Chapter 2: Intercultural Communication

1. Key Concepts

- **Globalization:** The increasing interconnectedness of the world.
 - *Positive:* Greater cultural exchange and intercultural dialogue.
 - *Negative:* Threatens or alters local traditions due to constant external influences.
- **Intercultural Communication:** Communication between people belonging to different cultures.
- **Ethnocentrism:** The belief that one's own culture is inherently superior to others.

2. Marilyn Loden & Judy Rosener's Diversity Wheel

Classifies individual diversity into two major dimensions:

- **Primary / Core Dimensions (6 Key Dimensions):**
 1. Age
 2. Gender
 3. Race
 4. Ethnicity
 5. Sexual orientation
 6. Physical and mental abilities
- **Secondary Dimensions:** Socio-economic status, religion, education, work experience, geographic location, first language, etc.

3. Barriers to Intercultural Communication (*Verderber & MacGeorge, 2016*)

- **Anxiety:** Fear or nervousness during unfamiliar cross-cultural encounters.
- **Assumed Similarity or Differences:** Mistakenly assuming everyone acts like you, or exaggerating differences to the point of alienation.
- **Ethnocentrism:** Judging other cultures exclusively by the standards of one's own.
- **Stereotyping:** Oversimplified, rigid generalizations applied to an entire cultural group.
- **Incompatible Communication Code:** Differences in language, dialect, idiom, or nonverbal signals.
- **Incompatible Norms and Values:** Clashing beliefs on what is acceptable, polite, or moral.'

4. Intercultural Competence (*Darla Deardorff, 2004*)

The ability to interact effectively and appropriately in intercultural situations based on attitudes, knowledge, skills, and reflection.

- **Motivation:** The genuine desire to engage and understand different cultural backgrounds.
- **Tolerance for Ambiguity:** The patience to handle uncertainty, confusion, and language barriers calmly.
- **Open-Mindedness:** Willingness to suspend judgment, listen, and provide a psychologically safe environment.

Chapter 3: Varieties and Registers of English

1. English as a Global Language & World Englishes (WE)

- **Lingua Franca:** English functions as the common global language for trade, science, business, and media.
- **World Englishes:** Localized varieties of English developed across distinct linguistic contexts.
- **Bautista & Gonzales (2006):** Structural variations in new Englishes emerge from the influence of speakers' mother tongues (L1 transfer).

2. Braj Kachru's Three Concentric Circles of English

Circle	Status	Demographics Characteristics	Representative Countries
Inner Circle	ENL (English as a Native Language / L1)	~400M speakers; transmitted via family, school, and media; norm-providing.	USA, UK, Canada, Australia, New Zealand.
Outer Circle	ESL (English as a Second Language / L2)	~350–450M speakers; official/institutional role in government, education, law; norm-developing.	Philippines, India, Singapore, Malaysia, Nigeria, Ghana, Pakistan.
Expanding Circle	EFL / ELF (English as a Foreign Language / Lingua Franca)	~1B speakers; learned for international business, research, diplomacy; norm-dependent.	China, Japan, Russia, Korea, Brazil, Egypt, Saudi Arabia.

3. Andy Kirkpatrick's Identity-Intelligibility Scale (2007)

Describes the tension in World Englishes between two competing goals:

- **Extreme 1: Goal of National/Regional Identity:** Prioritizes local accent, vocabulary, and grammar to mark cultural identity (Risk: reduces clarity for outsiders).
- **Extreme 2: Goal of International Intelligibility:** Adjusts speech toward international norms to ensure universal clarity across global speakers.

4. Classification of "Lects"

- **Dialect:** Variety based on **geographic region** (e.g., American English vs. Philippine English; Manila Tagalog vs. Cavite Tagalog).
- **Sociolect:** Variety based on **social group or class** (e.g., Jargon, Conyo, Jejemon, Swardspeak).
- **Idiolect:** The unique, individual speech pattern of a **single person** (e.g., favorite catchphrases, personal pacing).
- **Ethnolect:** Variety associated with a specific **ethnic/cultural group**.
- **Ecolect:** Variety unique to a single **household or family** (e.g., private inside jokes, family pet-names).
- **Chronolect:** Variety distinct to a **specific generation or time period** (e.g., Gen Z slang: *rizz*, *slay*, *delulu*, *no cap*).

5. The 5 Language Registers

1. **Frozen:** Static, historic language that never changes (e.g., national constitution, religious prayers, marriage vows).
2. **Formal:** Professional, academic, or legal settings; strict grammar, restrained tone, zero slang, no contractions.
3. **Consultative:** Standard professional dialogue with an expert/advisor (e.g., doctor-patient, teacher-student); polite, uses courtesy titles.
4. **Casual:** Informal conversation among friends, peers, family, and coworkers; uses contractions, idioms, and slang.
5. **Intimate:** Private communication between romantic partners or extremely close individuals.

Chapter 4: Understanding and Evaluating Multimodal Texts

1. Multimodality & The 5 Semiotic Modes

A text is **multimodal** when it combines **two or more** communicative modes:

- **Linguistic:** Words, vocabulary, grammar, and generic structures (print or spoken).
- **Visual:** Color, vectors, viewpoint, visual framing in still or moving images.
- **Aural:** Sound, music, pitch, tone, rhythm, volume, and voice delivery.
- **Gestural:** Movement, facial expressions, body language, and speed/stillness.
- **Spatial:** Layout, proximity, organization, direction, spacing, and physical positioning of text/elements.

2. Forms of Multimodal Texts

- **Paper/Print:** Books, posters, comics, brochures.
- **Digital:** Slide decks, animations, films, blogs, web pages, video games.
- **Live:** Oral presentations, theatrical performances, live staging.

- **Transmedia:** A single cohesive narrative told across multiple platforms and delivery channels simultaneously (e.g., story spanning novels, films, and video games).

3. Key Concepts of Media Literacy (Center for Media Literacy, 2005)

1. **All media messages are "constructed"** (constructed representations, not raw reality).
2. **Media have embedded values and points of view** (reflects worldviews and selective framing).
3. **Each person interprets messages differently** (audience context shapes meaning).
4. **Media have commercial, ideological, or political interests** (created with specific motives/funding).
5. **Media messages are constructed using a creative language having its own rules** (uses deliberate visual, technical, and editing conventions).

4. The 4 S Qualities of an Effective Message

- **Simplicity:** Clear core message and evident purpose.
- **Specificity:** Concrete, precise language rather than abstract or easily misconstrued terms.
- **Structure:** Logical arrangement of ideas.
- **Stickiness:** Smooth transitions and ideas that remain memorable and impactful.

5. Multimodal Composition Checklist

When creating or analyzing any multimodal message, three elements are essential:

- **Purpose:** The explicit reason the message exists.
- **Audience:** The values, sensibilities, and background of the target viewers/readers.
- **Context:** The medium, platform, and cultural environment where the text will be interpreted.